

15. After the system reboots, you are presented with the now famous blue screen (no, not the fatal error one); this is the OOBE or Out-Of-The-Box Experience screen of Windows XP, where you can specify other users, and provide them rights to use the computer as well as activate Windows (extremely important), and also register your copy of the OS with Microsoft. For registering your OS, you need to be online.

After Installation

After the installation of Windows XP is done, there are some steps you need to perform before you start using the OS.

1. Since you have upgraded your OS from Windows 98 to Windows XP, check if all the pre-installed applications are working fine. Some applications may not work, and you will need to re-install those. More details in the troubleshooting section of this chapter.
2. Similar to checking your software, check if the installed hardware is working fine. Older chipset drivers are detected automatically by Windows XP, and should not trouble you much. Check the device manager and see if you can find any hardware which shows problems (indicated by an exclamation mark in a yellow box).
3. If you can connect to the Internet, check for the most critical updates for Windows XP. These updates are mostly small in size, and should not take much time to download, even over a dial-up connection.
4. Customise your system to your heart's content. Windows XP is similar to previous versions of Windows in almost all aspects. It's just a matter of time before you start feeling that you've been using Windows XP all your life!